

Linux Standard base 1.0.0

At last! A move to bring all the warring Linux groups under one roof. The Linux Standard Base 1.0.0 specification is finally available for review by developers.

Right now, distributors like RedHat, Caldera, SuSE, etc, use the basic Linux kernel along with their own non-standard applications and standards based software around it. These differences in distributions create major problems for the developers who have to program around them.

Many a time, these incompatibilities cause feelings that Linux is an OS that only

'techies' can use. This is a big stumbling block in the wide spread acceptance of Linux.

Linux Standard Base 1.0.0 is expected to eliminate these problems and enable developers to more easily create software for Linux.

This standard is the collective effort of many software and hardware companies to create a base Linux operating system. This base standard has been designed with the goal of conforming to available standards. Some of the major players in this combined effort are Compaq, IBM, HP, Oracle, and RedHat.

quicktake

Dr Albert R. R. Kooiman, Program Director, Telephony, Philips Processing.

▲ What are the major products that Philips Speech Processing (PSP) is offering in India?

The SpeechPearl family is integrated with third-party applications for speech processing applications such as directory assistance, Internet voice browsing, personal call assistant and controlling unified messaging.

SpeechMania acts as an interface for automated telephone transactions in applications such as voice portals using SpeechPearl. It acts like a virtual telephone operator for services like directory assistance, voice portals, etc.

SpeechWave has been intended for use in small to medium-sized vocabularies like regional languages.

▲ What are the plans of PSP for India?

Most of the R&D work in India is focused on improving the acoustic models used for speech processing.

We have recently set up a voice portal in association with DSQ-world.com. It makes use of Philips's virtual telephone operator for providing information services such as news via the telephone to users. The technology is based on a speech processing

which makes use of Indian English. We are also developing speech recognition for Hindi. We even have plans to make acoustic models for four more languages. We plan to establish a network of competent partners in India who will integrate our technologies into products and applications.



Dr Kooiman
PROGRAM DIRECTOR
Speech Processing

Redalert

Marijuana

Marijuana is an Internet worm crafted in Visual Basic. It installs itself as system32.exe in the default system folder (depending on the OS). The worm however fails to install if the OS is installed in a path or drive other than the default location. After making its entry into the registry, the worm modifies run keys and adds itself to the win.ini, to ensure that it's loaded every time the computer is booted. The worm stays as a service in the memory thereafter. The worm then opens the Outlook address book and sends itself to all the contacts. It also changes the Windows registered user name to "I am a pot head!" and the organisation into "Stoner's pot place". The worm stays as a bush-like icon in the system tray and when clicked displays a lengthy message urging the legalisation of pot smoking. To delete the worm, delete the

system32.exe file from the Windows directory. The file would be locked in the Windows mode and hence has to be deleted via DOS mode.

Missworld

This mass mailing worm comes disguised as a Macromedia Flash movie. The mail comes to you with the subject line "Missworld". The body will read, "Enjoy the pictures of missworld from various countries" and carries attachments called either MWrld.exe, or Missworld.exe, or MWld.exe. The worm enters your Outlook address book and sends itself to all the contacts. It also adds a line to the Autoexec.bat instructing the computer to format C: drive upon reboot. McAfee has rated the worm a low risk one. Yet, erasing the hard disk means loss of valuable data. All the leading antivirus vendors have come up with patches, which will detect it. So get the latest updates for your antivirus program.

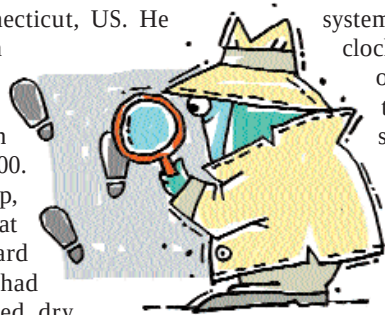
Big brother's watching you

It sure seems so, considering that technologies like GPS are increasingly being used to monitor people without their knowledge.

Take the case of this man from Connecticut, US. He rented a van fitted with a GPS system in October 2000. After his trip, he found that his debit card account had been drained dry due to three \$150 withdrawals. Acme Rent-a-Car, the car rental company, explained

this by saying that he had speeded three times during his trip. The result was the three \$150 fines per speeding.

Acme had installed AirIQ, an auto navigational system, which clocked him at over 90 mph in three areas. He sued the company and received a ruling in his favour. This incident has raised concerns that technology is being misused against its user. Is 1984 going to happen after all? →



◆ AMD in second-quarter free fall ◆ Hopeful signs emerge for technology spending upturn ◆ PC sales fall for first time in years